released during the four-day truce, and 150 Palestinians imprisoned in Israel will be liberated. During the ceasefire substantial humanitarian aid will be delivered to the enclave. One assumes that further groups will be liberated if the ceasefire is prolongated. The families are on edge, understandably so. Netanyahu declared that the war will continue until Hamas is destroyed. It does not look that way. The one to promise death and destruction all around is Gallant. Yesterday he prophesied that the leaders of Hamas are living on borrowed time. It is nonsense and does not absolve Gallant for the abysmal lack of preparation in the defense forces to deal with the catastrophe of October 7.

The director of Al-Shifa Hospital has been arrested by the Shin Bet for interrogation about Hamas's alleged activities in the hospital.

Omer Bartov, a former student of mine in the 1970s, who over the years became a professor and a well-known specialist in the Holocaust, has caused a firestorm by accusing Israel of genocidal intent in its attacks in Gaza. The trouble is that Israel cannot let Hamas survive with its 1988 charter (revised in 2017) advocating the destruction of the Jewish state, as it will, in one way or the other, repeat its murderous attacks.

I understand Bartov's motivation in the face of so much death and destruction, but I do not agree with his accusation. What is the alternative for Israel? I actually am for a cessation of hostilities, but it is because I see the human catastrophe involved and not because I think that Israel has to stop its operations forthwith because it is committing genocide.

It is impossible to know, in the midst of the fighting, which Israeli operations are militarily necessary, and which are dictated by sheer indifference to civilian casualties. It seems that some operations, like the bombing of the Jabalia refugee camp, are more likely the latter. "It is worse than a crime," as Talleyrand said about the killing of the Duke of Enghien, "it is a mistake."